

LINGUISTICS

Overview

Linguistics is a cross-disciplinary program designed to meet the needs of students interested in various aspects of language—its structure, history, varieties, meanings, and uses. The program includes courses in anthropology, computer science, English, psychology, and world languages and cultures, thus providing a multi-disciplinary approach to the study of human language.

Courses in linguistics serve as background for students interested in any career that involves working with language, such as teaching English as a first and as a second language, second language studies, speech-language pathology, cross-cultural communication, law, linguistic anthropology, computational linguistics, and psycholinguistics.

In the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, courses in linguistics can be applied as electives or as part of the group requirements. They may also be used in a minor or in a major. Linguistics majors earn a Bachelor of Arts.

Learning Outcomes

Students who major in Linguistics at Iowa State University will be able to

- communicate knowledge of the primary areas of linguistics (phonetics, phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics, and pragmatics) clearly and accurately, using appropriate linguistic terminology.
- identify and critically evaluate the applications of descriptive and prescriptive approaches to language use and analysis.
- demonstrate an understanding of the hierarchical and systematic nature of human language and critically evaluate how language systems shape communication, cognition, and culture.
- demonstrate a critical understanding of the linguistic, social, and technological factors that drive language variation and change.
- critically evaluate technological tools, methods, and approaches used in linguistic inquiry and analysis.
- apply methodological and collaborative skills to linguistic research by
 - analyzing organized and unorganized linguistic data.
 - designing and conducting linguistic research, for example, through literature reviews, data collection, and interpretation of findings.
 - communicating well-supported linguistic arguments in spoken and written form.

Linguistics Degree Requirements

Majors in Linguistics complete a minimum of 36 hours in Linguistics courses with a grade of C or better in each Linguistics course. Courses specifically required are:

LING 1190	Introduction to World Languages	3
LING 2070	Introduction to Symbolic Logic	3
LING 2190	Introduction to Linguistics	3
LING 2200	Descriptive English Grammar	3
LING 3710	Phonetics and Phonology	3
LING 4130	Psychology of Language	3
LING 4200	History of the English Language	3
LING 4370	Grammatical Analysis	3
Linguistics elective courses (see below)		12
Total Credits		36

Choose 12 credits of elective courses. Discuss choices with the advisor. Suggested areas of further study are:

Computers and Linguistics

LING 3200	Topics in Linguistic Structure	3
LING 3310	Theory of Computing	3
LING 4100	Language as Data	3

Second Language Studies

ENGL 3220	Language and Society	3
ENGL 3240	Introduction to Teaching ESL Literacy	3
ENGL 3250	Teaching Methods for ESL Learners: Oral Communication Skills	3
LING 4250	Second Language Learning and Teaching	3

Sociolinguistics and Language

ENGL 3190	Studies in Language Use	3
ENGL 3220	Language and Society	3
LING 4220	Language and Gender	3

Spanish Linguistics

LING 3510	Introduction to Spanish-English Translation	3
LING 3520	Spanish Pronunciation	3
LING 3540	Introduction to Spanish-English Interpretation	3
LING 4620	Contrastive Analysis of Spanish/English for Translators	3
LING 4630	Contemporary Spanish Linguistics	3

Additional courses in Linguistics include ANTHR 3090 and special topics offered through LING 3190 and LING 3200, which are repeatable for different topics. These additional courses also include courses for study

abroad, especially LING 3950, and independent studies through LING 4900. Majors in Linguistics must show proficiency in a second language equivalent to that achieved after two years of university-level study. Alternatively, majors in Linguistics can demonstrate university-level study in two other languages of at least one year each.

Communication Proficiency requirement: According to the university-wide Communication Proficiency Grade Requirement (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#communicationproficiencytext>), students must demonstrate their communication proficiency by earning a grade of C or better in ENGL 2500.

ENGL 1500	Critical Thinking and Communication	3
ENGL 2500	Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition	3
	or ENGL 2500H Written, Oral, Visual, and Electronic Composition: Honors	
LIB 1600	Introduction to College Level Research	1
Continuing Communication Proficiency is based on one course from ENGL 3140; WLC 3700A, 3700B or 3700C.		

For information about using linguistics courses in an Interdisciplinary Studies Major, see Interdisciplinary Studies (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/interdisciplinaryprograms/interdisciplinarystudies/>).

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, Linguistics students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated above for the major.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level. You must also complete the LAS world language requirement and career proficiency requirement.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities from the approved list of courses (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/us-cultures-and-communities-courses/>) and a three-credit course in International Perspectives from the approved list of courses (<https://www.registrar.iastate.edu/international-perspectives-courses/>). Discuss with your adviser how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

Linguistics, B.A.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 LING 1010	1
LIB 1600	1 Humanities Choice	3
World Language/Elective	4 Math Choice	3
LING 1190	3 PSYCH 1010	3

Natural Science Choice	3 World Language/Elective	4
	14	14

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 2500	3 LING 3710	3
LING 2190	3 World Language 2020	4
ANTHR 2010	3 LING 2200	3
Humanities Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
World Language 2010	4 Social Science Choice	3
	LAS 2030	1
	16	17

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
LING 3090	3 LING 2070	3
LING 4370	3 LING 4130	3
ENGL 3050, 3140, WLC 3700A, WLC 3700B, or WLC 3700C	3 LING 4200	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	3
Elective	3 Elective	3
	15	15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
LING Area of Concentration	3 LING Area of Concentration	3
U.S. Cultures and Communities	3 Electives	9
Electives	11	
	17	12

Undergraduate Minor in Linguistics

The undergraduate Minor in Linguistics is individually tailored to the interests of the student, who consults with the Linguistics Undergraduate Adviser to develop the minor program of study. The minor requires 15 credits in Linguistics courses; at least 9 credits must be numbered 2000 level or above, of which at least 6 credits are in courses numbered 3000 level or above. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement. All programs must include LING 2190 Introduction to Linguistics.

The Linguistics Undergraduate Minor is an LAS Minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Minor in Teaching English as a Second Language (TESL)

The Minor in Teaching English as a Second Language (TESL) is for undergraduate students.

The TESL Minor (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/teachingenglishsecondlanguage/>) provides concentrated coursework that prepares students to teach English to nonnative speakers of English, either in community programs in the United States or in an overseas location. Students from any program may complete the minor without further studies in Linguistics.

For more information, please contact the Linguistics Undergraduate Adviser.

CONCURRENT B.A. IN LINGUISTICS AND M.A. IN TESL/APPLIED LINGUISTICS

A concurrent B.A. in Linguistics and M.A. in TESL/Applied Linguistics offers well-qualified students the opportunity for accelerated study, achieving both degrees within a 5-year time frame. A student enrolled in this program pursues a graduate M.A. degree while simultaneously completing the requirements for the B.A. in Linguistics. Completing the concurrent degree program would enable students to enter the workforce one year earlier than through the traditional M.A. degree pathway. Up to six credits can be double-counted toward the requirements for both degrees. Students applying for the concurrent degree program should be motivated, focused, and able to handle a 16+ credit hour/semester schedule.

For more information on the Concurrent B.A. in Linguistics and M.A. in TESL/Applied Linguistics (<https://apling.engl.iastate.edu/concurrent-b-a-in-linguistics-and-m-a-in-tesl-applied-linguistics/>), visit the English Department website.

Graduate Minor

A graduate minor in linguistics permits students to investigate various aspects of linguistics, emphasizing the ability to think about language in a systematic and disciplined way and to apply the methods of the field to research problems in their own disciplines. Graduate courses for the minor may be cross-listed with courses in Anthropology, Communication Disorders, Computer Science, English, Psychology, and World Languages and Cultures.

For those pursuing a master's degree, a declared minor in linguistics consists of 9 credits in linguistics.

For those pursuing a PhD degree, a declared minor in linguistics consists of 12 credits in linguistics.

Undergraduate courses in linguistics at the 3000 and 4000 level can be used towards the minor, subject to approval by the minor representative on the Academic Plan Committee and the Graduate Minor advisor. PhD candidates will write one section of the preliminary examination on an area of linguistics. At least one member of the linguistics faculty will serve on a student's Academic Plan Committee as the minor representative. A list of faculty members may be obtained from the Linguistics program website.

Students in the Master's in Teaching English as a Second Language/ Applied Linguistics are not eligible for a graduate minor in linguistics.